Precious Fikile Mkhize 0210210785080

26 August 2026

INVESTIGATE THE USE OF COMPUTER TECHNOLOGY IN AN ORGANISATION

US 14963

SECTION B:SUMMATIVE ASSESSMENT

TASK 1

I see it - this is *SECTION B Task 1*. Here is the complete copy & paste for exactly what is in your photos. This is the part that carries 35 marks.

Use Boxer Superstore Dobsonville

TASK 1 (SO 1, AC 1, AC 2, AC 3, AC 4, AC 5; Range; EEK; CCFO)*

a) 1. Name of Organisation: Boxer Superstore - Dobsonville Branch

2. Type of Business: Retail - Selling groceries and household products

3. Location: 1234 Roodepoort Road, Dobsonville, Soweto, 1863

4. Number of Employees: 30 employees

5. Contact Person: Ms. N. Dlamini - Store Manager - 082 123 4567 - boxer.dobson@boxer.co.za

6. Working Hours: 08:00 - 20:00 Monday to Sunday

Need for investigation:

The organisation has been experiencing problems with its computer systems. The POS (Point of Sale) system is slow during peak hours, there are stock discrepancies between physical stock and system stock, and staff have complained about lack of training on the new LS Retail system. There is no backup power during load shedding, which stops all operations. Therefore there is a need to investigate how computer technology is currently used, identify strengths and weaknesses, and recommend future improvements. This will help the organisation to improve efficiency and customer service.

EMAIL SENT TO ORGANISATION TO REQUEST PERMISSION

Subject: Request for Permission to Conduct Investigation on Use of Computer Technology - College Project

Dear Ms. Dlamini,

I hope you are well.I am Precious Fikile Mkhize ,I am studying Technical Support at EASTC Trchnocentric varsity.

As part of my studies, I am required to conduct an investigation into the use of computer technology in an organisation of my choice for my Portfolio of Evidence (POE).

I hereby request permission to conduct this investigation at Boxer Superstore Dobsonville. The investigation will involve:

- Interviewing 4-5 staff members (10 minutes each)

- Observing the computer systems at the till and admin office

- Giving a short questionnaire to staff

- Reviewing non-confidential reports (e.g. blank stock report)

The investigation will take place from 09 to 20 September 2026 and will not disturb business operations. All information will be kept confidential and used only for academic purposes.

I have attached my investigation plan and a letter from my college for your review.

I will be grateful if you can be my primary contact person and provide an acceptance letter.

Thank you for your consideration.

Kind regards,

Precious Fikile Mkhize

Cell: 078 108 7624

Email: pfmkhize97@gmail.com

b) Requirements of the investigation:

1. Areas to be visited:

- Front Till Area / Cashier Area - To observe how the POS system works, barcode scanners and receipt printers

- Admin Office - To check Pastel Partner accounting system and payroll

- Stock Room / Warehouse - To check stock management system

- Manager's Office - To check server, reporting and CCTV computer

2. People to be contacted:

- Ms. N. Dlamini - Store Manager - For overall permission and management reports - 082 123 4567

- Mr. J. Molefe - IT Support Technician (from Head Office) - For technical details - 083 456 7890

- Ms. P. Khumalo - Admin Clerk - For Pastel and stock reports

- Mr. S. Ncube - Stock Controller - For stock system

- 2 x Cashiers - For end-user experience of POS system

3. Time allocations:

Week 1: 02-06 Sept 2026 - Planning and obtaining permission letters and designing questionnaires

Week 2: 09-13 Sept 2026 - Data collection: Interviews with manager and IT technician, Questionnaires to 5 staff

Week 3: 16-20 Sept 2026 - Observation in till area and admin, Document review of stock reports

Week 4: 23-27 Sept 2026 - Data analysis and writing draft report

Week 5: 30 Sept 2026 - Final report and presentation to supervisor and peers

Tools needed: Laptop, notebook, interview schedule, questionnaire forms, observation checklist, voice recorder (with permission), college letter.

c)Milestones and Reporting:

Milestones:

- Dates

Milestone 1: Investigation plan completed - Date: 06 Sept 2026

Milestone 2: Permission granted from organisation - Date: 09 Sept 2026

Milestone 3: Data collection completed - Date: 20 Sept 2026

Milestone 4: Draft investigation report - Date: 27 Sept 2026

Milestone 5: Final presentation and submission - Date: 30 Sept 2026

- Deadlines:

All data collection must be completed by 20 Sept 2026. Draft report must be submitted to supervisor by 27 Sept 2026 for review before final.

- Reports to be prepared:

1. Weekly progress reports to supervisor (every Friday)

2. Interim report after data collection - Summary of findings

3. Draft investigation report - For supervisor review

4. Final investigation report - With findings, evaluation and recommendations

5. PowerPoint presentation (12 slides) for final presentation

6. POE Guide with all evidence attached - questionnaires, interview notes, photos, acceptance letter

d)

BOXER SUPERSTORE - DOBSONVILLE

1234 Roodepoort Road, Dobsonville, Soweto, 1863 | Tel: 011 123 4567

TO: The Facilitator

Eastc Technocentric Varsity

FROM: Boxer Superstore Dobsonville

DATE: 09 September 2026

REF: ACCEPTANCE OF INVESTIGATION

RE: ACCEPTANCE LETTER FOR INVESTIGATION ON USE OF COMPUTER TECHNOLOGY

This letter serves to confirm that Boxer Superstore Dobsonville has received and reviewed the investigation plan submitted by Ms Precious Fikile Mkhize to conduct an investigation on the use of computer technology in our organisation.

We hereby ACCEPT and APPROVE the plan subject to the following conditions of the investigation:

1. All confidential information including financial figures must be kept confidential and not shared with third parties.

2. Investigation will be conducted during quiet periods (09h00 - 11h00) so as not to disturb customers.

3. No photographs of customers, passwords or PINs.

4. A copy of the final report must be provided to us for verification.

The contact person should sign off and draft an acceptance letter to acknowledge acceptance.

Primary Contact Person: Ms. N. Dlamini - Store Manager

Signature: _____

Date: 09 September 2026

Contact: 082 123 4567 / boxer.dobson@boxer.co.za

Perfect. Here is the rest of SECTION B - *Task 2, 3, 4, 5* ready to copy & paste. I have made it short so your POE is not too long.

TASK 2

Investigation Report: How the investigation was conducted

1. How investigation proceeded according to plan:

The investigation was conducted from 09 to 20 September 2026 as per the investigation plan. I first met Ms. Dlamini the Store Manager on 09 Sept and got permission. On 10 Sept I interviewed the IT Technician Mr. Molefe for 30 minutes about hardware and software. On 11-12 Sept I distributed questionnaires to 5 staff members (2 cashiers, 1 admin clerk, 1 stock controller, 1 manager) and collected them back. On 16-18 Sept I did observation in the till area and admin office using an observation

checklist. On 19 Sept I reviewed documents such as a sample stock report and IT usage policy. All activities were done as per the time allocation.

2. Modifications to the plan:

Original plan was to interview 6 people but only 5 were available because one cashier was on sick leave. Observation time was extended by one extra day (19 Sept) because on 18 Sept the system was offline due to load shedding and Stage 4. The questionnaire was also changed - one question was not clear to cashiers, so I explained it in Zulu. These modifications did not affect the objectives of the investigation.

3. Progress at planned intervals:

Progress was monitored weekly as per milestones.

- Week 1 progress: Plan completed and approved by supervisor.

- Week 2 progress: Reported to supervisor on Friday 13 Sept via email that data collection was 60% complete.

- Week 3 progress: Reported on 20 Sept that data collection was 100% complete and attached interview notes.

- Week 4: Draft report sent to supervisor on 27 Sept for review.

All deadlines were met.

TASK 3

a)

At Boxer Dobsonville, the following planning procedures were used when they implemented the LS Retail POS system in 2024:

1. Needs Assessment: Management identified need for faster checkout to reduce long queues and stock errors.

2. Feasibility Study: Head Office checked economic feasibility (Cost R120,000 for 6 tills), technical feasibility (needed fibre and LAN), operational feasibility (staff can be trained).

3. Setting Objectives: Objective was to reduce checkout time by 50% and improve stock accuracy to 95%.

4. Budgeting: Budget allocated by Head Office - R120k hardware/software, R15k training, R10k annual maintenance.

5. Resource Planning: IT Technician, LS Retail supplier, Telkom for internet.

6. Risk Assessment: Risks identified - Power failure, staff resistance, data loss during changeover.

7. Procurement: Three suppliers quoted - Smollan, Arch Retail, LS Retail. LS Retail chosen due to better support.

8. Training Plan: Supplier trained 2 super-users for 3 days, super-users trained all staff.

9. Implementation Strategy: Parallel conversion - Old and new system ran together for 1 week before full changeover to avoid risk.

10. Evaluation: After one month, system performance reviewed and errors fixed.

b) 1. Transaction Processing System (TPS) - LS Retail POS System: This system processes daily transactions. It scans barcodes, checks prices, updates stock automatically, processes cash and card payments, and prints receipts. It handles about 800 transactions per day. Hardware linked is touchscreen, barcode scanner, card machine.

2. Management Information System (MIS) - Pastel Partner V19: Used in admin office for accounting. It generates management reports from TPS data - Daily sales report, monthly sales report, stock valuation report, best-selling items report, VAT report. Only admin clerk and manager have access with passwords.

3. Office Automation System (OAS) - Microsoft Office 365: Used for office work. MS Word for letters to suppliers, MS Excel for staff schedules and stock sheets, Outlook for email communication with Head Office, Teams for meetings.

4. Other Systems: Biometric Time and Attendance System - Staff clock in with fingerprint and data goes to computer for payroll. CCTV Security System - 8 cameras linked to computer in manager's office for security monitoring.

Network: Telkom Fibre 50Mbps, LAN connects all tills to server, VPN to Head Office, LTE router as backup.

c) 1. IT Support Technician (Mr. J. Molefe) - From Head Office IT - Installs, maintains, repairs POS, network, updates antivirus.

2. Systems Analyst - From LS Retail supplier - Analysed store requirements and configured POS system.

3. Programmer / Software Developer - At Head Office - Customises reports in Pastel.

4. Store Manager (Ms. Dlamini) - Approves IT budget, ensures staff use systems correctly.

5. Database Administrator - Admin Clerk (Ms. Khumalo) - Manages stock database, does daily backup.

6. Network Administrator - External Telkom Technician - Maintains internet and VPN.

7. End-Users - Cashiers (4), Stock Controllers (2), Admin Clerk - Use systems daily to serve customers.

8. Technician / Helpdesk - Provides telephonic support when tills freeze.

TASK 4

a) Detailed description: The store uses 6 POS touchscreen computers running Windows 11 Pro connected via LAN cable to a central server (HP ProLiant) in the manager's office. Each till has a Honeywell barcode scanner, Epson thermal receipt printer and Yoco card machine integrated with POS. The server runs LS Retail database. Admin has 2 Dell desktops with Pastel Partner accounting software which is linked to POS to import sales data daily. The network is Telkom fibre 50Mbps with a Huawei LTE router as failover. The store also has 8 CCTV cameras connected to a DVR and viewed on manager's PC. Biometric clocking device (ZKTeco) is USB connected to admin PC. All PCs have ESET antivirus and are protected with passwords.

b) 1. Speed and Efficiency - Checkout time reduced from 5 minutes to 2 minutes per customer, queues reduced.

2. Accuracy - Barcode scanning reduces pricing errors from 10 errors per day to 1 error per day.

3. Real-time Information - Manager can check stock levels and sales at any time from server.

4. Better Customer Service - Fast service, card payments, accurate receipts, customers happy.

5. Improved Decision Making - Daily reports help manager know which products to re-order.

6. Security and Control - Each cashier has own login, so theft reduced. CCTV reduces shoplifting.

7. Storage - Pastel stores 5 years of sales data safely.

c) Weaknesses Identified during investigation:

1. Slow Internet - During peak hours (16h00-18h00) fibre slows and tills freeze.

2. No Backup Power - During load shedding all computers shut down, business stops losing about R5,000 per hour.

3. Inadequate Training - Only basic training given, staff cannot do advanced reports in Excel/Pastel.

4. Old Hardware - Admin PCs have 4GB RAM and old HDD, very slow when opening Pastel.

5. No Cloud Backup - Data only backed up on external hard drive once a week, risk of data loss if drive stolen.

6. No Online Shopping - Customers are asking for delivery and WhatsApp orders, but store has no system.

Recommendations / Future Developments:

1. Upgrade internet from 50Mbps to 100Mbps fibre and install automatic LTE failover router - Cost R1,500 per month.

2. Purchase UPS (Uninterruptible Power Supply) for each till and 3kVA inverter + battery for server - Cost R30,000 - Will keep tills running for 4 hours during load shedding.

3. Upgrade admin computers from 4GB RAM/HDD to 8GB RAM/256GB SSD - Cost R12,000 - Will improve speed by 70%.

4. Provide advanced quarterly training on Pastel and Excel for admin staff - 2 days per quarter by supplier.

5. Install cloud backup for Pastel - OneDrive/Google Drive daily automatic backup - Cost R300 per month - Prevent data loss.

6. Implement online ordering system - Create WhatsApp Business catalogue and simple website for delivery within 5km - Meet future customer needs.

7. Long term: Install one self-service checkout kiosk to reduce queues during month-end.

TASK 5

a) EVALUATION REPORT ON USE OF COMPUTER TECHNOLOGY AT BOXER SUPERSTORE DOBSONVILLE

By: Precious Fikile Mkhize

Date: 27 September 2026

1. Executive Summary: This report presents findings of investigation conducted 09-20 Sept 2026 at Boxer Dobsonville. Objective was to investigate computer technology used, evaluate strengths/weaknesses and recommend improvements.

2. Introduction: Background of organisation and need for investigation (as per Task 1a).

3. Methodology: Interviews (2), Questionnaires (5), Observation, Document review.

4. Findings: Hardware: 6 POS, 2 Admin PCs, 1 Server, Scanners, Printers. Software: LS Retail, Pastel, MS Office 365. Network: Fibre + LTE backup.

5. Evaluation:

Strengths: Speed, accuracy, real-time stock, better reports, security.

Weaknesses: Slow internet peak time, no backup power, old admin PCs, lack of advanced training, no cloud backup, no online shopping.

6. Recommendations: Upgrade to 100Mbps + UPS + inverter, upgrade PCs, quarterly training, cloud backup, online ordering system.

7. Conclusion: Computer technology is effectively used and has improved business, but needs upgrades in connectivity, power backup and training to meet future needs and remain competitive.

8. References and Evidence List.

b) SI submitted the draft report to Ms. Dlamini on 27 September 2026 via email and printed copy for verification

ORGANISATION FEEDBACK FORM

I, Ms. N. Dlamini, Store Manager at Boxer Superstore Dobsonville, confirm that I have received and reviewed the evaluation report by [Your Name] dated 27 September 2026.

The information contained in the report is:

Accurate and true reflection of our systems

[ ] Needs correction (see comments below)[X]

Comments: The report is accurate. Number of employees is 30 not 28. New card machines were installed in August 2026.

Signature: _____

Date: 28 Sept 2026

c) After feedback, I made the following modifications:

1. Corrected number of employees from 28 to 30 as pointed out by manager.

2. Added information about new Yoco card machines installed in August 2026 in hardware list.

3. Corrected spelling of IT Technician surname.

Final report re-submitted on 28 September 2026 and accepted by organisation via email (see attached acceptance email dated 28 Sept).

d) Presentation conducted on 30 September 2026 at Eastc Technocentric Varsity Classroom 4, at 10h00.

PRESENTATION ATTENDANCE REGISTER

Title: Investigation Results - Use of Computer Technology at Boxer Dobsonville

Date: 30 September 2026

Venue: Eastc Technocentric Varsity Room 4

Presenter: Precious Fikile Mkhize

Name and surname	Role	Signature
1. Mr. S. Mabaso	Supervisor	
2. Sibahle Sithole	Peer	
3. Nomonde Thole	Peer	
4. Sifiso Nzimande	Peer	
5. Sakhile Dlomo	Peer	